

William D. Larsen, MBA, CTS, CETL, CIT

Author and Educator in AV and Live Event Production

bill@backstageessentials.com | 651-270-2738 | Cottage Grove, MN | backstageessentials.com | ORCID:
orcid.org/0009-0002-7157-8582

SCHOLARLY IDENTITY AND RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied researcher and practitioner educator working across live event production, audio-video technology, and workforce development. My scholarly work focuses on how stagehand and technician craft is learned, taught, and transmitted across the live event industry. My instruction is grounded in direct field practice: I design lighting for professional productions, write the national certification exam working AV professionals take to prove their craft, and have run crews at major venues from Target Center to RiverCentre. My forthcoming book from Routledge, *Backstage Essentials: Skills for Stagehand Technicians in Live Event Production*, is the first practitioner-authored training guide of its kind for the field. Research interests include competency-based education in technical disciplines, job task analysis as a curriculum development methodology, AV-over-IP as an emerging workforce competency, and the pedagogical challenges of teaching hands-on production skills in online and hybrid environments.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration

Cardinal Stritch University, Milwaukee, WI, 1999

Business Administration. Graduate coursework in management, organizational behavior, strategy, marketing, managerial finance, accounting, economics, and quantitative analysis.

Bachelor of Arts, Communication Studies

University of Iowa, Iowa City, IA, conferred May 1989

Major: Communication Studies. Coursework in film production, broadcasting, directing, playwriting, film theory, and theatre. Transfer credits from UW Stevens Point (1986 to 1987) and UW Marshfield/Wood County (1984 to 1986).

Associate of Arts

University of Wisconsin Colleges, Marshfield/Wood County, WI, awarded June 1986

Coursework concentrated in theatre and communication, including Theatre Laboratory, Introduction to Theatre, Fundamentals of Acting, and Introduction to Stagecraft.

Associate in Applied Science, Medical Assistant

Minnesota School of Business, Richfield, MN, 1996

Medical Assistant program, 3.91 cumulative GPA.

Non-Degree Graduate Coursework, Vocational Technical Education

University of Minnesota, Twin Cities, 2000 to 2001

BIE 1301 Introduction to Vocational-Technical Teaching; BIE 5629 Course Development.

CERTIFICATIONS

- CTS — Certified Technology Specialist, AVIXA (Certificate No. 401698)
- CETL — Certified Education Technology Leader, CoSN (Certificate No. 21590)

- CIT — Cabling and Infrastructure Technician, CEDIA (Certificate No. 500049)
 - AVIXA SME — Subject Matter Expert, CTS Certification Exam Development (active)
-

PUBLICATIONS

Books

- Larsen, W. D. (forthcoming 2026). Backstage Essentials: Skills for Stagehand Technicians in Live Event Production. Routledge / Taylor and Francis. Technical editor: Chuck Espinoza, SCN Hall of Fame (2018), BNCO Consulting.
- Larsen, W. D. (published). Computerized Medical Office Procedures: A Worktext. Saunders / Elsevier. 4 editions (2003, 2nd ed., 3rd ed. 2011 ISBN 978-1-4377-1608-5, 4th ed.).

Periodicals

- Larsen, W. D. (featured author). Protocol Magazine. Industry publication for AV and live event professionals.
-

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Higher Education

AUD 260 Video Production for Live Events

Laurus College, Online, Summer 2026 to Present

Teaching Assistant transitioning to Instructor of Record. Five-week term, synchronous online. Core content: live video signal flow, multi-camera production, live switching, projection specification, camera operation, AVoIP.

The Show Must Go On: Inside the World of Live Event Production

OLLI at University of Minnesota, Fall 2026

Course Leader. Single 90-minute session, online via Zoom. Adult learners 50-plus.

ASB 110 Personal and Professional Assessment / ASB 208 Introduction to Management

Cardinal Stritch University, Milwaukee, WI, approx. 2002 to 2006

Instructor of Record. Accelerated evening format, adult and non-traditional learners.

Introduction to Business

Anoka Ramsey Community College, Spring 2002

Instructor of Record.

Technical Writing and Healthcare Law

Southern Illinois University, approx. 1999 to 2002

Adjunct Faculty. Taught at Camp Lejeune and Great Lakes Naval Base. Adult learners in active military service.

Sole Faculty Member, Medical Assistant Program

Century College, Fall 1999 to May 2001

Instructor of Record. Six courses: Administrative Procedures, Pharmacology, Clinical Procedures I/II/III, Laboratory Procedures, and Clinical Practicum.

Adjunct Instructor

Minnesota School of Business, approx. 1998 to 1999

Courses: Microsoft Word, Excel, Medical Office Procedures I and II, Anatomy and Physiology, Introduction to Film.

Program Director and Instructor, Medical Assistant Program

Rasmussen College, Eagan, MN, April 2005 to April 2008

Full program direction: curriculum, accreditation (CAAHEP/ABHES), budget, enrollment, externship coordination, and advisory board.

Program Director and Instructor, Medical Assistant Program

National American University, Roseville, MN, September 2008 to September 2011

Full program direction: curriculum, accreditation, budget, enrollment, and externship coordination.

RELEVANT INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

District AV Technology Coordinator

ISD 197, West St. Paul, MN, February 2018 to Present

Designed and launched a credit-bearing Live Event Production Workshop (CTE elective). Built and lead Tech Warriors student production crew, now a district strategic plan target. Directed a \$400,000 auditorium modernization. Lead game-day broadcast productions on Daktronics systems (NFL/NBA/MLB platform).

Subject Matter Expert, CTS Certification Exam

AVIXA, Ongoing

Write and review national CTS exam content using job task analysis methodology.

Adjunct Instructor, Audio Video Production

Laurus College, Online, 2026 to Present

AUD 260 Video Production for Live Events. Canvas LMS, five-week terms.

Education Coordinator and Training Developer

IATSE Local 490, 2026 to Present

Develop and coordinate training for union membership. Restarted the training committee.

Freelance Stagehand

IATSE Local 13 referral system, 2014 to Present

Freelance stagehand work including engagements at Encore/PSAV and other venues.

Camera Operator, Live Sports Streaming

School Space Media Denver LLC, 2023 to 2025

Camera operator for live streaming of high school sporting events.

Educational Coordinator

American Red Cross Tissue Services, Eagan, MN, August 2002 to January 2005

Coordinated compliance training and staff education on tissue services procedures.

PRESENTATIONS / PENDING

Students Run the Help Desk: A Tech Pipeline

CoSN 2027, Orlando, FL, April 12 to 14, 2027

Proposal 1011. Decision expected September 2026.

Whose Job Is the Network Now: AV Meets IT

CoSN 2027, Orlando, FL, April 12 to 14, 2027

Proposal 1013. Co-developed with Jessica Larson. Decision expected September 2026.

Building Mentorship for Early Career Technicians When Senior Mentors Are Scarce

USITT27, Baltimore, MD, March 17 to 20, 2027

Presentation Number 3047. Education track. Decision expected September 2026.

THEATRICAL LIGHTING DESIGN

Lighting Designer

Theatre in the Round Players, Minneapolis, MN, 2016 to Present

Legacy of Light (2025), Men on Boats (2024), Doubt (2022), The Government Inspector (2019), Comedy of Errors (2019), The Metromaniacs (2018), Deathtrap (2017), Sense and Sensibility (2016), Romeo and Juliet (2016).

Upcoming: You're a Good Man Charlie Brown (2027).

Lighting Designer

Inver Hills Community College, recurring

Grand Horizons (2026), And Then There Were None (2025), A Hero's Nap (2025), These Shining Lives (2024), She Kills Monsters (2024), The Doctor in Spite of Himself (2023).

Lighting Designer

Selected venues, Twin Cities and SE Minnesota

Kiss of the Spider Woman, Teatro Del Pueblo (2025). The Birds, TheatreX (2025). West Side Story and The Music Man, Inver Grove Community Theatre (2024 to 2025). The 39 Steps, Chameleon Theatre Circle (2017). Elf Jr., A Nice Family Gathering, Strega Nona, Phipps Center for the Arts (2018 to 2019).

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Lighting and show control: ETC Ion/Element, Hog 4, GrandMA 2, DMX and wireless lighting networking, rigging and load/power calculations, 3-phase power and generator connection, grounding.

Video and live production: Multi-camera live production, live switching (OBS Studio, Blackmagic ATEM), video signal flow and routing, projection system specification and setup, camera operation, NDI, Adobe Premiere, DaVinci Resolve.

AV systems and networking: AV-over-IP (Dante, Artnet, sACN, NDI), Q-SYS, Symetrix, Extron, structured cabling and termination, rack fabrication, commissioning and verification, signal flow diagramming (Draw.io).

Instructional technology: Canvas LMS, Microsoft Teams, Brightspace (D2L), OBS Studio for instruction, Daktronics production software.

AFFILIATIONS / MEMBERSHIPS

- AVIXA (Audiovisual and Integrated Experience Association)
 - CEDIA (Custom Electronic Design and Installation Association)
 - CoSN (Consortium for School Networking)
 - USITT (United States Institute for Theatre Technology)
 - IATSE Local 490 (International Alliance of Theatrical Stage Employees)
 - IATSE Local 13 (former referral list member)
-

FILM AND MEDIA PRODUCTION CREDITS

Selected credits as director, producer, and gaffer. Full profile: [imdb.com/name/nm4307380](https://www.imdb.com/name/nm4307380)

- Cured (2016) — Gaffer
 - Savage Sentinels (2015 to 2016) — Gaffer
 - Evergreen (2014) — Gaffer
 - A Year and a Day (2014) — Executive Producer
 - Tourvall the Terrible (2013) — Gaffer, Key Grip, Lighting Director
 - The Boy Inside (2008) — Director, Co-Producer
 - SuperFortress to Space Shuttle (2008) — Director, Co-Producer
-

SERVICE AND PROFESSIONAL ENGAGEMENT

Education Coordinator (volunteer)

IATSE Local 490, February 2026 to Present

Restarted and lead the training committee. Building cross-local training partnerships.

CTE Advisory Board Member

ISD 197, 2018 to Present

Align CTE curriculum to industry standards and workforce needs.

City Producer

48 Hour Film Project, Minneapolis, MN, 2013 to 2014

Organized and ran the Minneapolis 48 Hour Film Project.